Business case: time value and costs

Human API · 26 October 2026 · synthetic concept analysis

1 · Opportunity and hypothesis

When people cannot find a decision or reach the colleague who knows it, they search again, send follow-ups or interrupt another expert. Human API would make each question a trackable request and use only files the person asking can already open.

The value estimate is time that might become available for other work. It is not cash saved unless the organization actually avoids a cost or produces more with that time.

Value pathways

- Less active time spent searching and rebuilding context.
- Fewer repeated interruptions and clearer handovers.
- Easier access to approved technical decisions for newer teammates.
- A visible record of who approved the workflow, what source was used and whether a person corrected it.

This is an unvalidated concept. There is no employee time study, customer feedback or measured company benefit.

2 · Illustrative value of time made available

Example assumptions: 500 employees; each has 2 work-blocking questions per week; 50 work weeks a year; and employee time costs AED 250 an hour after salary and employer costs. This creates 50,000 possible questions. None of these figures is a measured Presight baseline.

For each scenario: ‘suitable’ is the share allowed by the policy and file permissions; ‘used’ is the share employees actually submit; ‘solved’ is the share that gets an answer the requester accepts. Active minutes are time actually spent searching, not time waiting.

Case	Suitable × used × solved	Minutes saved per answer	Estimated time value / year
Low	30% × 40% × 50% (3,000)	10	AED 125,000
Base	40% × 60% × 70% (8,400)	20	AED 700,000
High	55% × 75% × 75% (15,469)	25	AED 1,611,328

Worked example: in the base case, 8,400 questions are accepted. If each avoids 20 minutes of active searching, that is 2,800 hours. At AED 250 per hour, those hours have an estimated value of AED 700,000.

Formula: 50,000 possible questions × suitable share × used share × solved share × minutes saved ÷ 60 × AED 250/hour. The high case is only a sensitivity example, not a forecast. Do not count idle waiting time or count the same saved interruption twice.

3 · Cost, sensitivity and commercial model

Annual cost assumption	Basis	AED
Engineering	0.7 FTE × AED 480k loaded	336,000
Operations and support	0.4 FTE × AED 480k loaded	192,000
Infrastructure / observability	Planning estimate	60,000
Security and privacy review	Planning estimate	120,000
Adoption and support	Planning estimate	32,000
Total before Microsoft licenses	Illustrative	740,000

The base estimate of AED 700,000 in time value is AED 40,000 below the example AED 740,000 yearly operating cost—and does not include added Microsoft licenses. This is not a break-even forecast: time value may not become cash savings. The demo has no AI model cost. If a language model is added later, include its hosting and usage cost.

Possible future ways to charge could include a fee per user or team, private hosting, connector setup or support. These are ideas only; no customer willingness to pay or market price was verified.

4 · Pilot design and investment decision

- Start with one opt-in, low-sensitivity team and existing approved documents.
- Baseline active search time, interruptions, response acceptance and time to accepted resolution.
- Track eligibility, adoption, supported-answer rate, citation correctness, abstention, correction, escalation, latency, cost per accepted resolution and access violations.
- Keep a human fallback, review source ACLs, and report zero access violations as a hard gate.

Decision gate: proceed only if active time savings are observed without unacceptable access, trust or correction issues; compare with a Copilot Studio workflow before funding a standalone product.

Do not claim company-wide financial returns from this estimate. Replace assumptions with measured pilot results and include actual Microsoft licensing, security operations and support costs.